JAMES MITCHELL

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GitHub: github.com/jmitchell-dev

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Engineer with 10 years of experience designing and building scalable backend systems. I've spent the last five years focused on infrastructure automation and helping smaller teams adopt modern deployment practices. I'm known for asking awkward questions in architecture reviews and actually following through on technical debt reduction. Most recently I've been working on distributed systems challenges and mentoring engineers who want to move into leadership roles.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Go, Python, Java, Bash, SQL

Cloud Platforms: AWS (EC2, RDS, Lambda, S3, CloudFormation), Google Cloud Platform

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis, DynamoDB

Tools and Platforms: Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Jenkins, GitHub Actions

Architecture: Microservices, Event-driven systems, Message queues (RabbitMQ, Kafka)

Monitoring: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

Version Control: Git, GitHub, GitLab

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

Vertex Digital Solutions

vertexdigital.io

Leeds, United Kingdom

August 2022 - Present

Led the migration of legacy monolithic payment processing system to microservices architecture, resulting in 40% reduction in deployment time and enabling independent scaling of services. Established infrastructure standards and documentation that reduced onboarding time for new engineers from three weeks to five days. Mentored four junior and mid-level engineers through technical promotion pathways, with two successfully moving into senior roles. Implemented automated disaster recovery procedures that improved RTO from four hours to fifteen minutes, validated through quarterly testing.

Senior Engineer

CloudBase Technologies

cloudbase.co

Leeds, United Kingdom

March 2019 - July 2022

Designed and implemented a Kubernetes cluster spanning three availability zones serving 150 million requests daily with 99.95% uptime SLA. Reduced infrastructure costs by 35% through resource optimisation and implementation of spot instance management using custom Go tooling. Built a comprehensive observability platform using Prometheus and Grafana that decreased mean time to resolution for incidents from forty minutes to

twelve minutes. Established code review practices and architectural decision records that improved code quality metrics and reduced production incidents by 28%.

Software Engineer

Nexus Systems Ltd

nexusSystems.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

June 2014 - February 2019

Developed core backend services for real-time data processing pipeline handling 500,000 events per second using Java and Kafka. Architected and deployed internal infrastructure automation framework using Ansible and Python, reducing manual server provisioning time from two days to thirty minutes. Migrated payment processing system from MySQL to PostgreSQL with zero downtime, implementing dual-write strategy and comprehensive data validation. Contributed to open source projects including contributions to Kubernetes networking and Terraform AWS provider plugins.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Leeds

Leeds, United Kingdom

2010 - 2014

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

github.com/jmitchell-dev/kube-cost-optimizer - Go tool for identifying unused Kubernetes resources and cost optimisation opportunities

github.com/jmitchell-dev/terraform-aws-vpc-factory - Reusable Terraform modules for AWS VPC infrastructure

github.com/jmitchell-dev/go-event-sourcing - Educational implementation of event sourcing patterns in Go

github.com/jmitchell-dev/prometheus-alerting-templates - Collection of production-ready Prometheus alert configurations